

One World, Different School Years

Name: _____ Class: _____

A new school year does not start in the same season everywhere. Summer holidays have different lengths, too. Let us look around the world.

Japan

In Japan, school starts in spring, in early April. The year ends the next spring, in late March. The summer holiday lasts about six weeks. It comes during the school year, from late July to the end of August.

Two Places in the USA

Even in the USA, states have different rules and schools have different dates. In Anchorage, Alaska, school usually starts in late summer, in August. It ends in late spring, in May. The summer holiday lasts about eleven weeks. In Miami-Dade, Florida, school also starts in late summer, around the middle of August. It ends in early summer, in early June. The summer holiday is about ten weeks long.

England

In Kent, England, the year usually starts in early autumn, around September 1. It ends in summer, in late July. The summer holiday lasts about six weeks. Dates can change from school to school.

The United Arab Emirates

In UAE public schools, the year usually starts in late summer, near the end of August. It ends in summer, around July 1. The summer holiday lasts about eight weeks.

Jersey: A Small Island

In Jersey, the year usually starts in early autumn, in early September. It ends in summer, in July. The summer holiday lasts about seven weeks.

How Long Is a School Year?

In Anchorage, the school year runs for about nine months. In Kent, it runs for about eleven months. Both include short holidays. In Japan, the year goes from one spring to the next, with holidays along the way.

Find and explain

1. Where does school begin in spring? _____
2. Is Japan's summer holiday at the end of the school year? Explain.

General local patterns; dates vary. Holiday lengths include weekends. A school-year span includes shorter holidays. Seasons use the Northern Hemisphere calendar. Official sources are linked on the main reading page.

A WhatsApp Message from Argentina

WHATSAPP MESSAGE / FROM: Carlito / South America

A Horse Before Class

Hi! I am Carlito from Patagonia, Argentina. My school is eighteen kilometres from home. On school days, my sister Micaela and I ride our horse, Chiverito, through the mountains. Bad weather can make the journey difficult. I want to be a vet. How do you get to school?

Classroom message based on a documented routine; not an original message or a direct quotation.

Source: On the Way to School, documentary, 2013

Read closely

1. Who rides with Carlito?

2. How far is his school?

3. What does he want to be?

Present Simple A · Routines

Choose the form that fits.

1. I (carry / carries) my bag.
2. Carlito (ride / rides) a horse.
3. He does not (walk / walks) the whole way.

Write two facts about Carlito. Use he in both sentences.

Your turn

Answer the question at the end of his message.

Seasons, Routines and Meaning

A. Find the meaning in context.

Circle the meaning that fits each sentence.

1. The nearby station is open.

A. close to this place B. far away

2. The kitchen is on fire.

A. cooking food on a grill B. burning

3. We offer our thanks to the teacher.

A. our expressions of gratitude B. a reason something happens

4. He bought a new ski.

A. the action of skiing B. one long piece of equipment

B. Use it.

Choose nearby or on fire. Write a new sentence that makes its meaning clear.

C. Compare school years.

1. In which season does school usually start in Kent?

2. How long is the summer holiday in UAE public schools?

3. Write one difference between the school calendars in Anchorage and Miami-Dade.

4. Does the school-year span mean lessons every day? Give a detail from the main reading.

An Email from India

EMAIL / FROM: Samuel / Asia

To: Our English class / Subject: My way to school

Four Kilometres Together

Hello! I am Samuel from India. I go to school in a wheelchair. My two younger brothers come with me. They push and pull my chair for four kilometres. Our route includes sand, rivers and palm trees. We make this long journey together. Who goes to school with you?

Classroom message based on a documented routine; not an original message or a direct quotation.

Source: On the Way to School, documentary, 2013

Read closely

1. Who helps Samuel?

2. How do they help? Give a detail from the message.

Present Simple B · Questions

1. Complete: Samuel's brothers (help / helps) him.

2. Complete: (Do / Does) Samuel use a wheelchair?

3. Write a question with Who. The answer is: His two younger brothers.

4. Ask a partner how they get to school. Write the question and answer.

Your turn

Answer Samuel's question. Then write one similarity or difference between your journey and his.

An Instagram Post from the Isles of Scilly

Listen first

Open the unit's Listen First page. Listen to the boat message before reading the box below. Listen once for the main idea, then again for details.

Who? _____ Where? _____

Why do they need a boat? _____

How long is the boat trip? _____

What do they do after the boat trip? _____

Now read and check

INSTAGRAM POST / FROM: Zoe and Isaac / Europe

The School Boat

Hi from Bryher! We are Zoe and Isaac. Our school is on Tresco, a nearby island. Every morning, we meet the other children where the boat stops. Our boat trip takes five minutes. Sometimes we see dolphins! Then we walk to school. Do you cross water on your way to school?

Classroom message based on a documented routine; not an original message or a direct quotation.

Source: BBC Teach, Life on the Isles of Scilly, 2024

Read closely

Do Zoe and Isaac always see dolphins? Which word tells you?

Your turn

Answer their question. Write one detail about your own journey.

Connect two messages

Choose one of the earlier messages. Write one similarity and one difference. Use a detail from each message.

A Reply from You

Plan your reply

Choose Carlito, Samuel, or Zoe and Isaac. Write a WhatsApp reply, an email reply, or an Instagram comment of 50–70 words. Answer their question and describe your school routine. Include how you travel, one negative sentence, one frequency word and two vocabulary entries from groups 03–05. Connect ideas with and, but or because.

My message is for: _____

My two vocabulary entries: _____ / _____

One detail from their message I want to respond to:

My reply

Check and revise

Does your reply answer the sender's question? Check your meaning first. Then check Present Simple, your negative sentence and spelling. Underline your two vocabulary entries. Improve one sentence after feedback.

Teacher: assess the message, supporting details and independent use of language. Completing a page alone does not establish vocabulary mastery.